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01. CORE VERTICAL RHYTHM

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Major narrative sections use the same basic hierarchy:

SECTION BOUNDARY

↓

~100px

↓

EYEBROW

↓

34px

↓

DISPLAY HEADLINE

↓

SUPPORTING COPY / CONTENT

This is the default narrative rhythm.

It should be treated as the starting point for new sections.

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02. STANDARD SECTION ENTRY

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DEFAULT DESKTOP / TABLET:

Visual section boundary → Eyebrow
≈ 100px

CURRENT APPLICATION:

THE FOUNDRY FOR BRAND DNA
100px

HOW WE BUILD
100px

FEATURED VENTURE

100px

DESIGNED DNA: SWITCH

100px

This is measured from the PERCEIVED visual boundary, not necessarily the nearest DOM wrapper.

Examples:

Image edge

→ 100px

→ THE FOUNDRY FOR BRAND DNA

Top of blue field

→ 100px

→ HOW WE BUILD

Top of Featured Venture field

→ 100px

→ FEATURED VENTURE

Top of Designed DNA composition

→ 100px

→ DESIGNED DNA: SWITCH

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03. MOBILE SECTION ENTRY

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The ~100px rhythm should generally survive on mobile.

Current system:

HERO

100px

HOW WE BUILD

100px

DESIGNED DNA

100px

FEATURED VENTURE
88px

FEATURED VENTURE is intentionally slightly tighter because the additional SWITCH + eSCRAMBLER identity layer makes the complete introduction taller.

Do not allow narrative sections to collapse to tiny 20–50px top gaps simply because the viewport is narrow.

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04. SECTION-ENTRY EXCEPTIONS

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100px is the DEFAULT, not an absolute universal rule.

An exception requires a compositional reason.

Current intentional exception:

MARSHALL
≈66px

Reason:

The animation / technical graphic above the Marshall introduction occupies the upper visual field.

Therefore:

TECHNICAL VISUAL
↓
66px
↓
THE CASE FOR DNA TRANSLATION: MARSHALL

The section does not LOOK tighter because the upper space already contains visual information.

RULE:

Do not measure empty CSS space alone.

Judge perceived visual space.

But do not introduce arbitrary exceptions.

An exception should be explainable by an actual visual element or structural difference.

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05. EYEBROW → DISPLAY HEADLINE

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STANDARD:

EYEBROW

↓

34px

↓

DISPLAY HEADLINE

This is now consistent at every tested width from 390px through 3840px.

CURRENT APPLICATION:

THE FOUNDRY FOR BRAND DNA

↓ 34px

THE BEST BRANDS DESERVE
MORE THAN MERCH.

HOW WE BUILD

↓ 34px

FROM BRAND DNA
TO SCALABLE VENTURES.

THE CASE FOR DNA TRANSLATION: MARSHALL

↓ 34px

ROCK & ROLL
NEVER DIES

DESIGNED DNA: SWITCH

↓ 34px

FROM ONE PRODUCT TO
AN ENTIRE SYSTEM.

This 34px relationship is one of the strongest repeated pieces of Silent Foundry's visual identity.

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06. EYEBROW TYPOGRAPHY

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Standard major-section eyebrow:

FONT
DM Sans

SIZE
10.88px

WEIGHT
300

TRACKING
2.72px

CASE
UPPERCASE

Current examples:

THE FOUNDRY FOR BRAND DNA

HOW WE BUILD

THE CASE FOR DNA TRANSLATION: MARSHALL

FEATURED VENTURE

DESIGNED DNA: SWITCH

Colour is NOT globally standardised.

Section-specific accent colours are intentional.

Examples include:

Gold

Cyan

Dark neutral

Do not change colour merely to make eyebrows identical.

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07. DISPLAY HEADLINE TYPOGRAPHY

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Major display headlines should share a compact character.

STANDARD LINE-HEIGHT:

0.92

Examples:

THE BEST BRANDS DESERVE
MORE THAN MERCH.

FROM BRAND DNA
TO SCALABLE VENTURES.

ROCK & ROLL
NEVER DIES

FROM ACQUIRED ASSET
TO NEW VENTURE.

FROM ONE PRODUCT TO
AN ENTIRE SYSTEM.

The Hero previously used 1.35.

That was removed because it made the two-line headline visually loose and made the eyebrow/headline relationship appear inconsistent.

RULE:

Do not use conventional body-text line-height for these display headlines.

They are intentionally tightly stacked.

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08. HEADLINE → BODY

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Do NOT currently standardise this to one exact pixel value.

The visual rule is:

EYEBROW
↓
34px
↓
HEADLINE
↓
CLEAR BREATHING SPACE
↓
BODY

The body should clearly read as the next level of information.

Different section structures currently make raw box measurements misleading, particularly because display headlines use 0.92 line-height.

Therefore:

Do not introduce a global headline→body number unless the design is later deliberately standardised.

Judge optical separation while maintaining the existing section composition.

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09. LEFT ALIGNMENT

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Within a standard narrative introduction:

EYEBROW
HEADLINE
BODY

should share a deliberate left axis.

Current measured examples at desktop:

HERO

48 / 48 / 48

HOW WE BUILD

216 / 216 / 216

MARSHALL

48 / 48 / 48

DESIGNED DNA

48 / 48 / 48

The absolute page X coordinate does NOT need to be identical between sections.

The INTERNAL axis does.

RULE:

Do not force every section onto one global X coordinate.

Do keep eyebrow, headline and body internally aligned unless the composition intentionally requires otherwise.

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10. SWITCH FEATURED VENTURE EXCEPTION

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Featured Venture has a different hierarchy:

FEATURED VENTURE

↓

16px

↓

SWITCH + eSCRAMBLER

↓

32px

↓

FROM ACQUIRED ASSET
TO NEW VENTURE.

↓

BODY

This is intentional.

Do NOT force:

FEATURED VENTURE

↓34px

HEADLINE

The brand identity lock-up is an intermediate information level.

The logo layer is part of the section architecture.

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11. CONSISTENCY PRINCIPLE

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Consistency means:

Same function

→ same visual relationship.

Therefore:

Narrative eyebrow → headline

= 34px

Standard narrative section entry

≈ 100px

Display headline line-height

= 0.92

Major eyebrow typography

= DM Sans / 10.88px / 300 / 2.72px

Exceptions require a reason.

Examples:

Marshall section entry
= technical animation occupies upper field

Featured Venture internal hierarchy
= brand lock-up sits between eyebrow and headline

Do not create exceptions merely because an old section happens to have different CSS.

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12. MARSHALL DNA KEY

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INTANGIBLE
TANGIBLE

are SECONDARY diagram information.

Current standard:

SIZE
8px

WEIGHT
300

TRACKING
1.92px

POSITION
Bottom-right of constellation

ALIGNMENT
Right aligned

Opacity distinction remains intentional:

INTANGIBLE
rgba(10,10,10,0.26)

TANGIBLE
rgba(10,10,10,0.38)

Typography reference:

EXPANDED MARKET

8px / 300 / 1.92px

RULE:

Diagram keys should not compete with primary diagram labels.

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13. MARSHALL CONSTELLATION HIERARCHY

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Visual hierarchy:

1.

EXTRACTED DNA

Section identifier

2.

PRESENCE

ACOUSTIC IDENTITY

PROVENANCE

ATTITUDE

TACTILE

MECHANICAL

VISUAL

CMF

Primary diagram information

3.

INTANGIBLE

TANGIBLE

Secondary diagram key

4.

RESULTS

Beginning of next information block

Do not allow level 3 to visually compete with level 2.

14. RESPONSIVE CONSISTENCY

Always check:

390
768
1024
1440
1920
2560
3840

A design relationship that represents identity should survive breakpoint changes.

Examples:

Eyebrow → headline
34px at ALL widths

Standard section entry
approximately 100px across widths

Display headline character
0.92 line-height across widths

Do not allow breakpoint-specific legacy rules to silently alter these relationships.

15. ULTRAWIDE

Ultrawide does NOT mean stretching the entire design.

Current production architecture intentionally constrains major visual frames.

Key ultrawide values currently include:

MEDIA
2200px

FRAME
1600px

HERO FRAME
2104px

SUBJECT
960px

At 2560 / 3840:

allow surrounding space to grow.

Do not simply make designed compositions fill the viewport.

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16. VISUAL WIDTH PRINCIPLE

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Sections should feel related in their maximum visual width.

Avoid:

one section stopping at a designed content frame
followed by another arbitrarily stretching to the viewport edge.

Use the established frame system.

Ultrawide whitespace is intentional.

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17. DISPLAY VS BODY HIERARCHY

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Display typography should feel:

compact
architectural
deliberate

Body typography should feel:

open
readable
secondary

Do not loosen display line-height to make it behave like paragraph typography.

Do not compress body typography to imitate the headlines.

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18. SECTION PACING

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The page should not feel uniformly spaced.

It should feel rhythmically consistent.

Difference:

BAD:

Every section has identical padding because of one global CSS variable.

GOOD:

Comparable narrative sections enter at approximately the same perceived distance.

Special compositions deviate only when an actual visual element explains the difference.

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19. PERCEIVED SPACE > DOM SPACE

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Always identify the VISUAL boundary before measuring.

Examples:

Hero:

image edge is the boundary.

How We Build:

blue field edge is the boundary.

Marshall:

technical animation participates in the entry composition.

Designed DNA:

preceding visual/film boundary is the reference.

Do not measure from an invisible wrapper and call the resulting number a design rule.

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20. NEW SECTION DEFAULT

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When creating a new standard narrative section, start here:

VISUAL SECTION BOUNDARY

↓

100px

↓

EYEBROW

DM Sans

10.88px

300

2.72px tracking

uppercase

↓

34px

↓

DISPLAY HEADLINE

0.92 line-height

↓

intentional larger optical separation

↓

BODY

Then deviate only when the composition provides a clear reason.

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21. DESIGN REVIEW RULE

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When something "feels wrong", check in this order:

1. Is the section-entry distance inconsistent?

2. Is the eyebrow → headline distance different from 34px?
3. Is the display headline using something other than 0.92 line-height?
4. Is the eyebrow typography inconsistent?
5. Are eyebrow/headline/body left edges accidentally misaligned?
6. Is another visual element legitimately changing the perceived spacing?
7. Is an old responsive rule overriding the intended production value?

Do not immediately redesign the section.

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22. PRODUCTION PRINCIPLE

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Do not create multiple experimental versions inside production code.

Design exploration can use variations during development.

Once a version is selected:

BAKE THE SELECTION.

Production should contain the selected design, not 10–50 old alternatives and JavaScript that chooses the final one after load.

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23. FIRST-PAINT PRINCIPLE

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The first visible state should be the approved state.

Never intentionally ship:

OLD DESIGN
→ JS LOADS
→ CURRENT DESIGN

This was specifically corrected for:

MARSHALL EXTRACTED DNA

and:

SWITCH PRODUCT PORTFOLIO

Static presentation that is known before runtime should be available for first paint.

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24. SILENT FOUNDRY SPACING SUMMARY

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STANDARD SECTION ENTRY
~100px

FEATURED VENTURE MOBILE ENTRY
88px

MARSHALL ENTRY
66px
justified exception

EYEBROW → HEADLINE
34px

FEATURED VENTURE → SWITCH LOGO
16px

SWITCH LOGO → HEADLINE
32px

DISPLAY HEADLINE LINE-HEIGHT
0.92

EYEBROW
DM Sans
10.88px
300
2.72px tracking

MARSHALL SECONDARY KEY
8px
300

1.92px tracking

These are the current production reference values.

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25. OVERALL RULE

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REPEAT RELATIONSHIPS, NOT JUST NUMBERS.

The design system should be recognisable because the same kinds of information behave the same way:

section begins

↓

identity appears

eyebrow

↓

headline

headline

↓

explanation

section identifier

↓

primary information

↓

secondary key

Use the numbers above to preserve those relationships.

Use optical judgement only where the composition gives a concrete reason to depart from them.